



WEEKEND LAND ESCAPE

RULEBOOK — KEYWORDS V2 EDITION

Version 0.10 (development)

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Early playtesting — subject to change

Rules only — no card gallery. Cover art: Tommy & Clover. All names and art are original.

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HOW TO READ THIS BOOK

This is a **development snapshot** of a game that is still being made. Every rule is tagged so you can tell settled facts from ideas under test:

LOCKED Decided by David. Won't change without a new edition.

CURRENT The playtest rules everyone uses today. Can still change.

WAVE 2 DRAFT Rules that come with the Wave 2 draft cards (Garrison, Upgrade).

PROPOSED Ideas being tested. **Not in effect** unless your table agrees to try them. They are collected in Appendix A.

The card wins. If a card's text disagrees with this book, do what the card says.

1 • QUICK START

Weekend Land Escape is a two-player fantasy card battle (more players can join, see Chapter 4). You play lands for mana, collect gold from your buildings, raise creatures and walls, and attack until your opponent runs out of life.

What you need

- One deck per player (40–60 cards today).
- Treasure tokens or coins for gold — about 20–40 shared.
- Paper or counters to track life. **No dice** are used.
- Small counters for damage (optional).

Setup

- Shuffle your deck. Each player starts at **20 life** and **0 gold**.
- Draw **7 cards**. You get one free mulligan: shuffle back and draw **6**.
- Pick the first player at random. They **skip their first draw**.

Your turn in 5 steps

1. **Ready.** Untap your cards. Upkeep: collect INCOME, pay UPKEEP.
2. **Draw** one card.
3. **Build.** Play one land, cast cards, pay Equip costs.
4. **Fight.** Attack with ready creatures. Your opponent blocks.
5. **Finish.** A second main phase, then discard down to 7. Damage wears off.

How to win

Bring your opponent from 20 life to **0**. With more players, the last one standing wins.

FIVE THINGS NEW PLAYERS FORGET

- A creature **can't attack the turn it arrives** unless it has Aggressive.
- Only **one land** per turn.
- **Mana is not gold**. Lands make mana for costs; gold comes from INCOME and Treasure.
- **Damage wears off** at the end of each turn — on creatures and on forts.
- With **5+ creatures**, pay 1 gold at upkeep or they get –1/–0 (the Supply check).

CURRENT Everything in Chapters 1–7 and 9 (except parts marked otherwise) is the current playtest rule set, as on the Rules page of the website. If a card disagrees with this book, the card wins.

2 · CARD ANATOMY

Cards are landscape: art on the left, rules on a side panel. Here is a creature from Wave 1.



Warpaint Marauder — a 1-mana Forge creature (original printing).

- 1 **Name** — Every card has its own name. Alternate versions of a Legendary share a name slot.
- 2 **Cost medallions** — What you pay to cast it: a number and a mana mark (here 1 Forge). Some cards also cost gold, shown with a coin.
- 3 **Type line** — Card type, then kind (Creature — Orc Warrior). Tribal cards care about the kind.
- 4 **Keyword plate** — The card's keyword, in large letters. This older printing shows Ferocity, a keyword retired in v0.10 (the card is now a 2/2 with no keyword). See the glossary, Chapter 8.
- 5 **Rules text** — What the card does. The card's own words always win over this book.
- 6 **Wave badge** — Which release the card belongs to (Wave 1, Wave 2 drafts, and so on).
- 7 **Power / Toughness** — 2/1: deals 2 damage in combat; dies once it has taken 1 damage this turn.

CARD TYPES

Type	What it does
Land	Tap for mana. Play one per turn. Basic lands have one mark; others may give a choice.
Creature	Attacks and blocks. Has power / toughness.
Artifact	Lasting objects. Mana artifacts (“rocks”) tap for mana; Relics support other cards.
Equipment	An artifact you attach to your creature by paying its Equip cost.
Fortification	A wall, tower or keep with DEFENSE. Protects and boosts your side.
Economy building	A Fortification — Economy with INCOME and UPKEEP. Makes your gold.

LOCKED These card types are locked. There are **no instants or sorceries yet** — you only cast cards during your own main phases.

Tokens are creatures or Treasures made by other cards. They are kept beside the table, not in your deck. **Legendary:** you may have only one of that name in play.

BUILDINGS: INCOME, UPKEEP AND DEFENSE

Fortifications and economy buildings have no power or toughness. Instead a row of tiles at the bottom shows what they earn, what they cost to keep, and how hard they are to knock down.



Camp Market — a 1-mana Bastion economy building.

- 1 **Name**
- 2 **Cost** — 1 Bastion.
- 3 **Type line** — Fortification — Economy.
- 4 **Rules text** — Abilities with a small icon each.
- 5 **INCOME / UPKEEP / DEFENSE** — +1 gold each upkeep, costs 0 to keep, destroyed by 2 damage in one turn.
- 6 **Wave**
- 7 **Rarity** — Common, Uncommon, Rare or Mythic. (Some early Wave 1 cards don't print it.)

3 · MANA & GOLD

There are two resources. **Mana** comes from lands and is used up when you spend it. **Gold** is money: you collect it, save it, and spend it on gold costs.

THE SIX MANA MARKS

Mark	Color	Symbol	Plays like
 Bastion	White	Castle tower and sunburst	Order, soldiers, markets
 Harbor	Blue	Lighthouse	Tempo: draw, dig, bounce
 Mire	Purple / black	Crowned raven	Removal, the undead
 Forge	Red	Crossed hammers	Aggression, war gear
 Wildwood	Green	Stag and leaves	Ramp, beasts
 Quarry	Grey	Stone shield	Artifacts and fortifications
 Gold	Gold coin	Coin	Money, not mana (see below)

LOCKED The six marks, their symbols and colors, and gold coins are locked. So is the card back. The game uses no dice.

MAKING MANA

- **Lands.** Tap a land for one mana of its mark. Play one land per turn, in a main phase.
- **Hybrid and tri-lands** let you choose one of two or three marks. Most lands with an upside enter tapped or need a condition.
- **Mana artifacts** (Quarry Keystone, Forge Heart, Mana Prism...) and some creatures also tap for mana.

PAYING COSTS

- Each mark in a cost must be paid with that exact mark: “2 Forge + 2 Bastion” needs two Forge and two Bastion.
- Quarry is its own mark (grey). It is not “any color”.
- A plain number without a mark (Scrag Warlord’s “3 mana”) can be paid with any marks.

GOLD

- Everyone starts with **0 gold**. Keep gold as Treasure tokens or coins in front of you. You get gold from **INCOME** at your upkeep, and from cards that give gold or make Treasure (1 Treasure = 1 gold).
- Gold pays gold costs: parts of a spell’s cost shown as coins, Equip costs, and UPKEEP.
- Gold can’t pay mana marks and mana can’t pay gold — unless a card says so (Militia Spear: “1 Forge or 1 Gold”).

4 · TURN STRUCTURE

Players take turns. Each turn has seven steps, always in this order.

#	Step	What happens
1	Untap	Untap all your tapped cards.
2	Upkeep	In this order: collect INCOME from your buildings; pay building UPKEEP ; pay Equipment UPKEEP (if you don't, the Equipment falls off but stays in play); Supply check : if you control 5 or more creatures, pay 1 gold or your creatures get -1/-0 until your next turn. “At your upkeep” abilities happen here too.
3	Draw	Draw one card. (The first player skips this on their first turn.)
4	Main 1	Play one land (optional). Cast creatures, artifacts, Equipment and buildings. Pay Equip costs. House or release garrisoned creatures (Wave 2).
5	Combat	Attack with your creatures (Chapter 5).
6	Main 2	Same as Main 1. If you didn't play a land in Main 1, you can play it now.
7	End	“At your end step” abilities happen. Discard down to 7 cards . All damage wears off and “until end of turn” effects end.

TIMING, KEPT SIMPLE

- There are no instants yet, so you cast cards **only in your own main phases**.
- Abilities say when they work: “Tap:”, “when this enters”, “whenever this attacks”, “at your upkeep”, “once per turn”. Do what the card says, when it says.
- Your opponent can act on your turn only through printed abilities (for example, Moonbow Archer pinging an attacker, or Court Mage countering a cheap spell).
- A creature that entered this turn can't attack. We also don't use its “Tap:” abilities that turn (this is how we playtest; the rules don't say it yet).

MORE THAN TWO PLAYERS

- **Free-for-all**: everyone starts at 20 life. Play goes clockwise. You may attack any opponent.
- **Two-headed teams**: each team shares **30 life** and one gold pool.

CURRENT Multiplayer rules are optional and lightly tested.

5 • COMBAT

1. ATTACK

- Choose which of your untapped creatures attack. A creature can attack only if you've controlled it since the start of your turn — unless it has **Aggressive**.
- Attacking creatures **tap**. (Playtest practice.)
- Each attacker attacks the defending player **or one of their Fortifications**. With more players, say which opponent (or which of their forts) each creature attacks.
- “When this attacks” abilities happen now (Rally, Snare, Charge...).

2. BLOCK

- The defending player may block with their untapped creatures. Each blocker blocks one attacker.
- Several blockers may team up on one attacker.
- Blocking doesn't tap the blocker. Unblocked attackers get through.

3. DAMAGE

- All combat damage happens at the same time. Each creature deals damage equal to its power.
- An **unblocked** attacker that attacked the player deals its damage to them; they lose that much life. (Attacking a fort: see below.)
- A **blocked** attacker and its blockers damage each other. If there are several blockers, the **attacker's controller** splits the attacker's damage among them.
- A creature with damage equal to or more than its toughness **dies** (to the graveyard).
- Damage stays until the end of the turn, then wears off.

EXAMPLE: A SIMPLE BLOCK

Ironfang Bruiser (3/2) attacks. Glade Scout (1/1) blocks.

The Bruiser deals 3 to the Scout: $3 \geq 1$, the Scout dies. The Scout deals 1 to the Bruiser: $1 < 2$, the Bruiser survives. The defending player loses no life.

EXAMPLE: A DOUBLE BLOCK

Ironfang Bruiser (3/2) attacks. Glade Scout (1/1) and Scrag Raider — Evasive (1/2) both block.

The attacker splits 3 damage: 1 to the Scout, 2 to the Raider — both die. They deal $1 + 1 = 2$ to the Bruiser: $2 \geq 2$, it dies too.

FORTIFICATIONS IN COMBAT

- Forts never attack. They have **DEFENSE** instead of toughness.
- A fort is **destroyed** when the damage dealt to it in one turn is equal to or more than its DEFENSE. Damage on forts wears off at end of turn like any other damage.
- **Attacking a fort.** Any creature may attack one of the defending player's Fortifications instead of the player. The defender may block it as usual. If it is **unblocked**, it deals **1 damage** to that fort.
- **Siege.** An unblocked creature with **Siege** deals its **full power** to the fort instead of 1.
- Abilities that name a fort (Fire Breath X, Burning Breath...) deal their printed damage; they don't need Siege.

- Many forts also help through their text: tougher creatures, less damage, or shooting attackers. If a fort's own text limits who can damage it, the card wins.

EXAMPLE: ATTACKING A WALL

Ironbelly Siege-Hurler (3/4, Siege) and Warpaint Marauder (2/2) both attack a Stone Curtain Wall (DEFENSE 6). Nobody blocks. The Hurler deals its full 3, the Marauder only 1: $3 + 1 = 4 < 6$, so the Wall stands. A second Siege creature ($3 + 3 + 1 = 7 \geq 6$) would knock it down.

CURRENT New in v0.10 (approved by David): **any unblocked creature attacking a fort deals 1 damage to it; a creature with Siege deals its full power.** This replaces v0.9's "Siege deals double damage to forts".

PROPOSED Still being tested, **not** a rule yet: **forts may block.** See Appendix A.

6 · FORTIFICATIONS & ECONOMY

FORTIFICATIONS

- Cast a fort in your main phase by paying its cost. It stays in play until destroyed.
- Its **DEFENSE** is how much damage in a single turn knocks it down.
- Most forts protect your side through their text, for example Earthen Berm (your creatures +0/+1) or Stone Curtain Wall (+0/+2).

ECONOMY BUILDINGS

- Economy buildings are Fortifications with **INCOME** and **UPKEEP** tiles. They also have **DEFENSE**.
- At your upkeep, collect **INCOME**, then pay **UPKEEP** in gold.
- If you can't or won't pay **UPKEEP**, that building makes **no income** this turn (some cards add a penalty, like Gemcutter's Deep Shaft).

EXAMPLE: JEWEL MINE

Jewel Mine has **INCOME** +3 and **UPKEEP** 2. Each upkeep you gain 3 gold and pay 2 back, so it earns you **+1 gold** a turn ($3 - 2 = 1$). Skip the upkeep and it earns 0 that turn.

EQUIPMENT

- Cast Equipment like any artifact. It enters unattached.
- In your main phase, pay its **Equip** cost (usually gold) to attach it to a creature you control. The creature gets the bonus while it's attached.
- Pay the Equip cost again to move it to another creature. If the creature leaves play, the Equipment stays in play, unattached.
- Some Equipment has **UPKEEP**. If you don't pay it, the Equipment falls off (but stays in play).

SUPPLY

Big armies cost food. At your upkeep, if you control **5 or more creatures**, pay 1 gold or your creatures get -1/-0 until your next turn.

GARRISON AND UPGRADE

WAVE 2 DRAFT These rules come with the Wave 2 draft cards. They are written down but still being playtested.

- **Garrison N (Type).** This fort can house up to N of your creatures of the listed troop type. In your main phase you may house an untapped eligible creature or release one (tuck it partly under the fort). Housed creatures get +0/+1, can't be targeted by opponents, and can still block. A housed creature that attacks leaves the garrison. If the fort is destroyed, its creatures stay in play, tapped.
- **Attacking out of a fort.** Some forts give a bonus to a creature that attacks out of their garrison; the card says what. (v0.9's "Sally" keyword is now written out as plain text.)
- **Upgrade (Building).** Cast it only on top of that building. The pair keeps its damage, gains the new text and uses the new INCOME, UPKEEP and DEFENSE. If it leaves play, both cards go to the graveyard.

Troop type	Which creatures count
A race or kind	Only creatures of that kind: Human or Dwarf, Orc or Scrag, Ogre, Elf, Centaur, Minotaur, Dragon...
Harbor creatures	Any creature with Harbor in its cost.
Any	Any creature.

7 · A WORKED EXAMPLE TURN

Let's play one full turn and check every number. It's **your turn 4**.

	You	Opponent
Life / gold	20 life, 1 gold	20 life
In play	Forge Peak ×2, Bastion Fields, Camp Market (INCOME +1, UPKEEP 0), Warpaint Marauder 2/2 (cast last turn)	Glade Scout 1/1, untapped
Hand	Forge Peak, Ironfang Bruiser (2 Forge, 3/2), Militia Spear (1 Forge; Equip 1 Gold: +1/+0)	—

Step	What you do
Untap	Your lands and the Marauder untap.
Upkeep	Camp Market pays INCOME +1: gold 1 → 2. Its UPKEEP is 0. You have 1 creature, so no Supply check.
Draw	You draw Hide Jack (1 Bastion; Equip 1 Gold: +0/+1).
Main 1	Play Forge Peak. You now have 3 Forge + 1 Bastion . Cast Ironfang Bruiser (2 Forge). Cast Militia Spear (1 Forge). Cast Hide Jack (1 Bastion). All four lands are used. Equip the Spear to the Marauder (gold 2 → 1): it is 3/2. Equip Hide Jack to it too (gold 1 → 0): it is 3/3.
Combat	The Bruiser just arrived and doesn't have Aggressive, so it stays home. Attack with the Marauder (3/3). Blocking would cost your opponent the Glade Scout (3 ≥ 1) without killing the Marauder (1 < 3), so they don't block: opponent 20 → 17.
Main 2	Nothing left to cast — no mana, no gold, no cards.
End	Your hand is empty (3 + 1 drawn – 4 played = 0), so no discard.

After the turn	You	Opponent
Life	20	17
Gold	0	—
Creatures	Marauder 3/3 (Spear, Hide Jack), Bruiser 3/2	Glade Scout

CHECK THE MATH

- ✓ Mana: made 3 Forge + 1 Bastion; spent 2 + 1 Forge and 1 Bastion.
- ✓ Gold: 1 + 1 income – 1 – 1 equip = 0.
- ✓ Marauder: 2/2, +1/+0, +0/+1 = 3/3.
- ✓ Life: 20 – 3 = 17.

What if they block? The Scout dies (3 ≥ 1), the Marauder lives (1 < 3), and your opponent stays at 20. **What if you attack a fort?** Had your opponent controlled a Wooden Palisade, the unblocked Marauder would deal it only 1 damage: it doesn't have Siege.

Note for v0.10: this example now uses the Keywords v2 cards. Warpaint Marauder is a 2/2 with no keyword (Ferocity is retired) and Ironfang Bruiser is a 3/2 without Aggressive.

8 · KEYWORD GLOSSARY

Keywords v2 cuts the 87 keywords of v0.9 down to **12 creature keywords**, exactly **two for each mana mark**. A card only carries keywords of its own marks (a multicolor card may use either mark's). Cards with one keyword print its reminder text; cards with two print the keywords bare, so the reminders live here. **The card's text always wins.**

Mark	Keyword	Reminder text	Cards
Bastion	Armored	Prevent 1 damage each time this is dealt damage.	9
	Rally	When this attacks, your other attacking creatures get +1/+0 this turn.	5
Harbor	Flying	Can only be blocked by creatures with Flying.	6
	Snare	When this attacks, tap target creature with less power.	4
Mire	Relentless	When this dies, you may pay 1 gold to return it to your hand.	9
	Lifedrink	When this deals combat damage, you gain that much life.	8
Forge	Aggressive	Can attack the turn it arrives.	11
	Fire Breath X	When this enters, deal X damage to target creature or fort.	8
Wildwood	Pack	+1/+0 while attacking alongside another creature.	7
	Camouflage	Can't be blocked by creatures with greater power.	5
Quarry	Charge	+2/+0 when attacking.	6
	Siege	Deals its full power to a fort it attacks. (Without Siege, an unblocked attacker deals just 1 damage to a fort. See Chapter 5.)	19

Cards = how many cards print or grant the keyword (tokens included).

HOW THE KEYWORDS FIT EACH MARK

- **Bastion** — order and armor: Armored makes the best blockers; Rally turns a wide line into a real attack.
- **Harbor** — tempo: Flying goes over the top; Snare taps a smaller blocker out of the way.
- **Mire** — attrition: Relentless buys a dead creature back for 1 gold; Lifedrink turns damage into life.
- **Forge** — speed and burn: Aggressive attacks at once; Fire Breath X shoots a creature or fort on arrival.
- **Wildwood** — packs and ambush: Pack rewards attacking together; Camouflage slips past bigger blockers.
- **Quarry** — earth and siege: Charge is a raw attack bonus; Siege hits forts for full power.

OTHER RULES WORDS

These aren't creature keywords and work as before.

Word	Meaning	Cards
Legendary	One copy per deck, one in play. Alternate versions of the same character share one slot.	17
Equip	Pay the Equip cost (usually gold) in your main phase to attach this to a creature you control.	19
Income	INCOME +N: gain N gold during your upkeep.	13
Upkeep	UPKEEP N: pay N gold at your upkeep. Unpaid: no income (buildings) or it falls off (Equipment).	14
Upgrade	Cast only on top of the named building you control; it uses this card's text, INCOME, UPKEEP and DEFENSE.	5
Garrison	Garrison N (Type): house up to N matching creatures. They get +0/+1, can't be targeted by opponents, and can still block.	25

Named abilities. A mythic or Legendary card may have one short named ability on top of its keywords (for example Crushing Tide, Burning Breath, Tribute of the Deep). The card explains it.

Retired in v0.10: Knockdown, Pounce, Drown, Slumber, Mist Form, Regenerate, Discorporation, Split, Loyal, Moonturn, Curse, Multi-Strike, Frightful Presence, Gaze, Mindless, Ferocity, Pack Tactics, Battle Roar, Battle Cry, Fury, Gore, Overrun, Slippery, Tunneler, Flyby, Flyer, Cover, Holdfast, Bulwark, Adamantine Hide, Frost Breath, Firestorm, Guard, Temper, Ranged, Sally, Seafarer, Mounted, Infantry, Muster, Raise, Charm, Wellbound, Ambush, Corrode, Babble, Defender, Amphibious and the other v0.9 keywords. Cards that used them now use one of the 12 keywords, plain text, or a small stat bump. Some cards pictured on the website still show their old printing until they are reprinted; play them by their updated text.

9 · DECK BUILDING

TODAY’S DECKS: 40–60 CARDS

CURRENT These are the deck rules in use now.

- **40 to 60 cards.**
- Up to **4 copies** of any card, except basic lands (as many as you like).
- About **24 lands per 40 cards** is the Rules page guidance. Playtests suggest fewer (about 40% lands) work well — see Appendix A.
- Treasure tokens are shared and kept beside the table (20–40), not in your deck.
- Pick one or two mana marks.

PLAN YOUR FIRST GOLD

Many strong cards need gold, but you start with none. Today only a few cheap cards give your first gold — mainly **Camp Market** (1 Bastion, INCOME +1) and **Deepvein Miner**. Put some in your deck, or your gold cards will be stuck in your hand. (Appendix A lists proposed fixes.)

A GOOD STARTING SPLIT

Card type	60-card deck	100-card deck (proposed)
Lands	24	40
Mana rocks / mana creatures	2	4
Creatures costing 1–2	8	12
Creatures costing 3–4	9	16
Creatures costing 5–6	4	8
Creatures costing 7+ / Dragons	1	3
Fortifications	4	7
Economy buildings	4	6
Equipment & other artifacts	4	4
Total	60	100

Creature costs count mana only, not gold. Fast decks can run a couple fewer lands; decks with big Dragons a couple more.

100-CARD DECKS

PROPOSED A proposal for bigger games. **Not locked** — David hasn't decided yet.

- Exactly **100 cards**.
- Up to **2 copies** of any non-land card.
- **Legendary** cards: 1 copy. Alternate versions that share a Legendary slot count as one (the three Count Valdreks; the Bleakcloud and Platebound alternates).
- Basic lands: unlimited.
- Tokens are not in the deck; keep them beside the table, like Treasure.
- Not decided: how many copies of a non-basic land. The website's Deck Builder allows 2 for now.

The website has two 100-card starter decks built this way: **Moonhunt Pack** (Wildwood/Forge) and **Night Court** (Mire/Forge).

APPENDIX A · PROPOSED RULES UNDER TESTING

Nothing in this appendix is a rule yet. These ideas come from playtest games and a computer simulation (September 24, 2026). Try them only if everyone at the table agrees. David will decide what becomes official.

A.1 THE BULWARK STRONGHOLD (RECOMMENDED PACKAGE)

Each player starts with a home base, the **Stronghold**, already in play. It makes gold every turn and has a wall of **Bulwark** counters that soaks up attacks before your life does. The study recommends this package over the other three it tested.

Setup

- Put a **Frontier Holdfast** into play (it isn't part of your deck) with **8 Bulwark counters**. Keep its two upgrade cards beside it.
- Start at **30 life** and **2 gold**. Draw 7 as usual.

How it works

- The Stronghold is **not a Fortification**: it can't be attacked, targeted, damaged, destroyed or garrisoned.
- Income**: +1 gold every upkeep (+2 and +3 after upgrades).
- Bulwark**: combat damage aimed at you removes Bulwark counters first; only the rest hits your life. Bulwark doesn't reset and can't be bought back with gold.
- Order when attacked**: creatures and forts block → damage reductions → Bulwark → life.
- Forts help**: each non-economy Fortification adds 2 Bulwark (up to three forts) and may **block one attacker** per combat. The attacker's damage goes to the fort's DEFENSE; the fort deals none back.
- Attacking forts is allowed** — any attacker may attack a Fortification instead of the player.
- Bombard**: in your main phase, pay 2 gold to deal 1 damage to an opponent's Bulwark (or to them if it's empty). Once per turn per Stronghold tier.

Tier	Card	Upgrade cost	Income	Bulwark	Bombards / turn
1	Frontier Holdfast	starts in play	+1	8	1
2	Stonewrought Holdfast	2 any mana + 2 gold	+2	11 (add 3)	2
3	High Holdfast	4 any mana + 5 gold	+3	14 (add 3)	3

DRAFT CARD TEXT (NOT PRINTED YET)

Frontier Holdfast — *Stronghold, Tier 1 (begins in play, not in your deck)*

“Income +1. Bulwark 8. Pay 2 Gold: deal 1 damage to an opponent's Bulwark, or them if empty. Once per turn.”

Stonewrought Holdfast — *Stronghold Upgrade (Frontier Holdfast). Cost: 2 any + 2 Gold*

“Income +2. Bulwark 11 (add 3 when this enters). Pay 2 Gold: deal 1 damage to an opponent's Bulwark, or them if empty. Twice per turn.”

High Holdfast — *Stronghold Upgrade (Stonewrought Holdfast). Cost: 4 any + 5 Gold*

“Income +3. Bulwark 14 (add 3 when this enters). Pay 2 Gold: deal 1 damage to an opponent's Bulwark, or them if empty. Thrice per turn.”

Name clash solved: Keywords v2 rewrote Sandbag Bunker's “Holdfast” and Stone Curtain Wall's “Bulwark” as plain text, so both words are free for this package.

Clean-up changes that come with the package

- **Dragons** get mostly generic (“any”) costs, e.g. Platebound Warwyrms: 4 any + 3 Forge + 1 Bastion + 4 gold.
- **Two-symbol rule:** no card needs more than 2 mana of one mark; extra symbols can be paid with any mana.
- **Rubblefist Bruiser** becomes 2/2. **Camp Market** becomes DEFENSE 3. **Storm-Eye Channeler's War Blessing** hits creatures only.
- Optional: at most 5 gold from buildings and the Stronghold in one upkeep.
- About 24 lands in 60 cards (40%). The earlier “Land Tithe” idea is dropped in this package.

A.2 PROPOSED BALANCE CHANGES (EARLIER LIST)

From the Deck Design page. Some of these are folded into the Stronghold package above.

1. **Land Tithe:** once per turn, tap a land for 1 gold instead of mana. (Dropped by the Stronghold package.)
2. **Easier Dragon costs:** mostly “any mana”; the biggest drop from 12 to 10 mana and 8 to 6 gold.
3. **Forts can block:** each non-economy Fortification may block one attacker per combat; damage goes to its DEFENSE.
4. **Land guideline:** about 40% lands, replacing “about 24 lands in 40 cards”.
5. **Tone down fast attackers:** Rubblefist Bruiser 2/2; Storm-Eye's 2 damage targets creatures only.
6. **Sturdier Camp Market:** DEFENSE 3 instead of 2.
7. **Gold income limit:** at most 5 gold from buildings in one upkeep.
8. **Equip floor:** discounts can't make an Equip cost less than 1 gold.
9. **Attacking forts:** attackers may attack a Fortification instead of the player. (**Adopted in v0.10** with the Siege fix — see Chapter 5.)
10. **Life totals:** 20 for 60-card games; 30 for 100-card games.

A.3 A 100-CARD COMMANDER FORMAT (IDEA)

A long-term idea: 99 cards plus a commander, 30 life, 1 copy of each card (or 2 while the card pool is small). Three ways to run the commander were considered:

- **Legendary Leader.** A Legendary creature starts in the command zone and sets your deck's marks (its marks plus Quarry). Each recast costs 2 more gold.
- **Warlord & Seat** (playtest favorite). A Warlord in the command zone plus its **Seat**, a building that starts in play and gives Income +1. The Deck page describes the Seat as a Fortification with DEFENSE 10 that blocks one attacker.
- **Banner.** A non-creature card in the command zone with one ongoing ability. Simple, but no board presence.

LATEST THINKING (STRONGHOLD STUDY)

The Seat should **replace the Frontier Holdfast** and use the same Income / Bulwark / Bombard frame plus one signature line — **not** a DEFENSE 10 blocker, which tested too strong. Life 30 in both formats; try Bulwark 10 in 100-card games. These two sources disagree, and David hasn't chosen.

APPENDIX B · CHANGE LOG

Milestones so far, from the project files and the website's git history. Times are Eastern (ET), mostly from file dates.

Date	Time (ET)	What happened
Sept 24, 2026		Weekend Land Escape started.
Sept 24	5:41 AM	Card back locked (card-back artwork).
Sept 24	5:44 AM	Six mana marks and gold coin locked (mana symbol sheet).
Sept 24	by 7:34 AM	First rules draft; CR conversion ladder for balancing locked (private reference).
Sept 24	8:39 AM	Wave 1 core catalog: 64 cards and the first 54-page rules-and-cards PDF.
Sept 24	9:14 AM	Tommy & Clover cover art approved.
Sept 24	1:18–1:27 PM	Race waves: Ogres, Dwarves, Elves, Humans and Centaurs (35 cards).
Sept 24	3:48 PM	Shareable public PDF builder.
Sept 24	4:38 PM	Website launched (commit f6f579f).
Sept 24	8:51 PM	Wave 2 design analysis.
Sept 24	9:03–9:08 PM	Wave 2 drafts: forts & Garrison, equipment, economy upgrades, lands (38 cards; commit 777892c).
Sept 24	9:10–9:22 PM	Playtest simulator and first playtest report.
Sept 24	9:14–9:27 PM	Minotaurs and stand-alone monsters; site at 159 cards (commit c29e2dc).
Sept 24	9:33 PM	Deck Design & Balance page (commit 9120e69).
Sept 24	9:36–9:47 PM	Monster waves: Vampires, Lycanthropes, Zombies, Wolves & Wargs and more; 193 cards (187 deck cards + 6 tokens).
Sept 24	9:47 PM	Rules v2 study: the Bulwark Stronghold proposal.
Sept 24	9:57 PM	Monster waves, gallery Deck Builder and proposed 100-card deck rules published on the site (commit 71deb4f).
Sept 24	evening	Rulebook v0.9 (archive edition).
Sept 25		Keywords v2: 87 keywords cut to 12 (two per mark), 137 cards updated. Siege fix: any unblocked attacker deals 1 damage to a fort; Siege deals full power. This rulebook, v0.10.

APPENDIX C · OPEN QUESTIONS

Things David still needs to decide. Until then, agree on an answer at your table before you play.

Combat and timing

- Do attacking creatures tap? (We play that they do; the rules don't say.)
- Fort cards that limit damage (Thousand-Banner Citadel: only Siege can damage it; Basalt Rampart: prevent 1 per hit) cancel the new 1-damage rule. Keep them as they are? (For now, the card wins.)
- Order inside upkeep: collect income before paying upkeep? (This book says yes.)
- Can a creature use “Tap:” abilities the turn it arrives?
- What happens when you must draw from an empty deck?

Keywords

- Reprinted cards say “Siege (Can damage forts.)”. Update to the full-power wording on the next reprint?
- Bleakcloud Devourer lost Flying in the remap. Keep it that way?
- Watch Relentless (1 gold to rebuy) and Fire Breath X aimed at forts in playtests.

Cards and costs

- Scrag Warlord — Command's cost is printed as “3 mana” with no mark.
- Rarity is missing on some early Wave 1 cards.
- Adopt the Dragon cost and two-symbol clean-ups?

Decks and formats

- Lock the 100-card rules? How many copies of a non-basic land?
- Keep 24 lands per 40 cards, or move to about 40%?
- Which commander option, and should the Seat block or use Bulwark?

Stronghold study (from the proposal)

- Is Bombard the right gold sink (2 gold, 3 gold, or Bulwark-only)?
- Should Siege matter against Bulwark? Can Bulwark ever be repaired?
- Does Bulwark soak ability damage? Does it count for Lifedrink?
- 30 life, or 25 life with a bigger Bulwark?
- Rename either the card keywords or the package words (Holdfast, Bulwark).

End of the v0.10 edition. Built September 25, 2026 by `build_rulebook.py`.